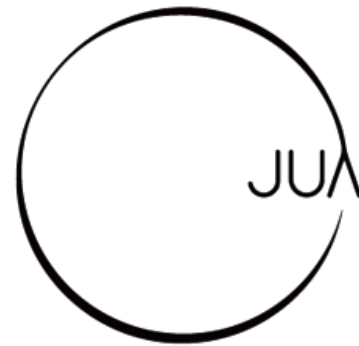
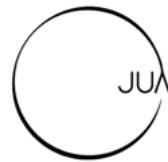




DAVID SHAW
NOVEMBER 17TH, 2021



CAVIAR KIM

Golden Ossetra Caviar | Crispy Nori Wrap | Truffle Rice | Beef Tartare
Pickled Mountain Yam | Soy-Braised Burdock

BANG-EO

Jeju Island Yellowtail | Soy Cured | Cold Smoked
Red Cabbage | Japanese Ginger | Jelly Fish
Yuja Pepper Sauce

JOOK

Korean Rice Porridge | Foie Gras | Spinach | King Trumpet Mushroom
Korean Gochu Pepper | Smoked Eel

ARCTIC CHAR

Asparagus | Leek Cream Butter Sauce
Fish Fumet Made with Smoked Fish Bone Marrow

DUCK & CHAN

Dry-aged Long Island Duck | Korean Banchan:
Herbs-Mustard Sauce | Brussel Sprouts | Persimmon | Soy-glazed Eggplant
Phogo Mushroom | Charred Cucumber | Cabbage kimchi
Perilla Leaf with Soybean Paste and Asian Pear

DANHOBAK

Pumpkin Purée | Pumpkin Ball | Pumpkin Tuile
Brown Butter Ice cream | Black Sugar Boba

HOTTEOK

Korean Sweet Pancake | Black Sugar Glazed
Candied Pecan | Cashew



JUA & CHEF KIM

Jua is a brand new, one-of-a-kind Korean restaurant by chef Hoyoung Kim. Chef Kim is a former executive chef of two-Michelin-starred Jungsik in Tribeca. Jua is the chef's gift to his firstborn daughter Jua whose name signifies "joie" in French. The restaurant utilizes a variety of wood-fire techniques to present an original 7-course tasting menu. Chef Hoyoung Kim spent 8 wonderful years working for Jungsik. He started as a line cook to eventually become an executive chef. Chef Kim is an alumnus of the culinary school Ecole Ferrandi in Paris. He also worked with chef Pascal Barbot at the Michelin three-star restaurant L'Astrance.



CAVIAR KIM

To kick off the menu, Jua presents me with one of the most iconic items of all time on Jua's tasting menu — the Caviar Kim. The gunkan-maki-shaped dish consists of golden Osetra caviar on top of beef tartare, truffle rice, pickled mountain yam, and soy-braised burdock wrapped in crispy nori. The combination of truffle rice, pickled mountain yam, and soy-braised burdock reminds me of the classical Kinpira Takikomi Gohan. The truffle flavor is reminiscent of a soft breeze that will not overshadow other ingredients. The beef tartare provides a rich unctuousness that counterpoints perfectly with the caviar. Overall, the dish introduces a rich diversity of flavors and textures. The contrast between the crispness of nori and the creaminess of beef tartare is fabulous. One concern of this course is that it reflects more of the Japanese style. However, we can connect this course with Jungsik's famous caviar and tuna tartare.

BANG-EO

Following the Caviar Kim is another raw dish of soy-cured and cold-smoked hamachi sashimi from Jeju island. Laying under the julienned red cabbage are three to four pieces of hamachi sashimi, mixed with Japanese ginger, jellyfish, and yuja pepper sauce (commonly known as yuzu pepper). The sashimi per se is well-prepared. It is cured precisely to the ideal level of brininess, and the smoking process offers the flesh a sophisticated depth. The use of red cabbage to coat the hamachi is confusing, but it is indeed a trend now in the avant-garde culinary world. Flavor-wise, it is a successful and secure way to combine red cabbage and sashimi. Personally, cabbage works better than endive, which is commonly seen in several new American restaurants. The garnish of Japanese ginger and yuzu pepper implies hints of spicy yet citrusy freshness to counter the heavy flavors obtained from curing and smoking processes. In contrast to the first course, this Bang-Eo dish showcases layers of nuances that are thought-provoking.





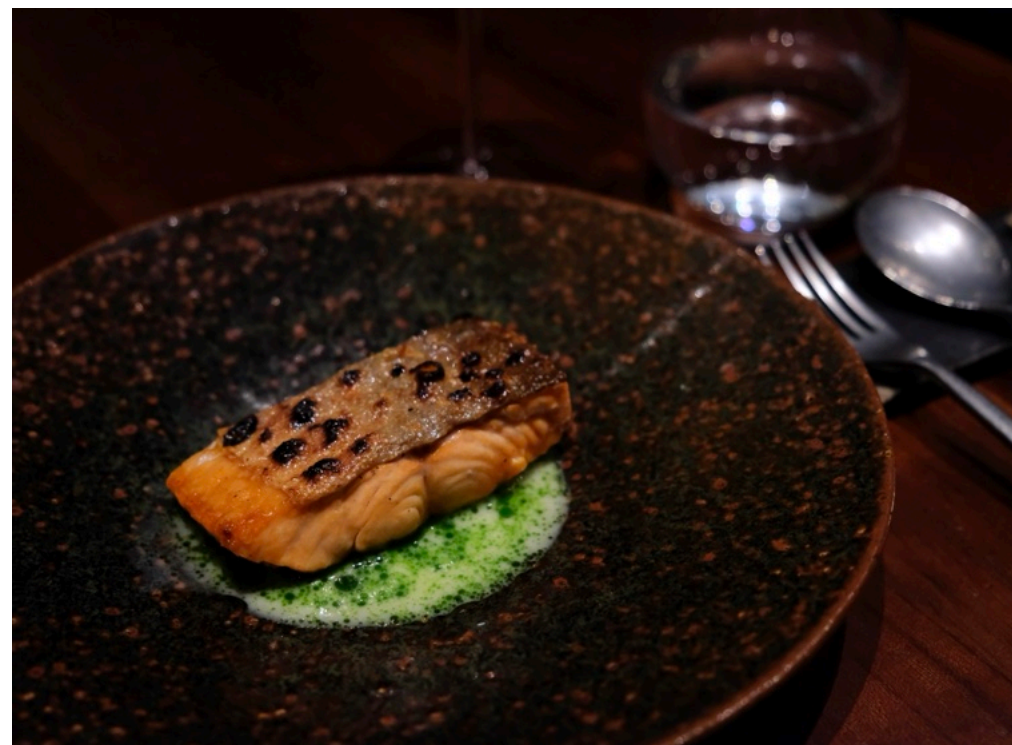
JOOK

After the two cold-served dishes, I am finally presented with the first hot course from the menu — a Korean version of porridge. The porridge consists of foie gras and smoked eel as well as garnishes including spinach, chives, king trumpet mushroom, and most importantly, the Korean gochu pepper. It

seems to be a simple dish, and the combination of spinach, chives, and mushroom sounds ordinary as well. However, the appliance of foie gras and smoked eel immediately lifts the whole porridge to another dimension with their rich umami. The rice is unfortunately not prepared to perfection as a small portion is still undercooked. Nonetheless, the thick and creamy broth does provide a satisfying equilibrium to the dish. A hint of spiciness is the crowning touch as it adds another sensation to our palate.

ARCTIC CHAR

For the first main course, a fish dish is presented. The arctic char is seared and butter-basted, and such method results in its airy crispy skin and tender succulent flesh. The arctic char per se is already amazing, not to mention the heavenly created jus. The jus is a high condensed mélange of dozens of layers of flavors. It is a leek cream butter sauce with the addition of fish fumet made with smoked fished bone marrow. The two textures of unctuousness from butter and marrow, the oceanic umami from the fish, the smoky perfume, and the earthy leek, all contribute to the medley. At the bottom of this dish is a base of simply cooked asparagus, which adds another texture and green tone to the whole symphony. The only concern for this course is its style again. This dish could be regarded as a Scandinavian dish or an avant-garde French plate. I see no Asian elements at all in this creation.





DUCK & CHAN

The final main course of the day is the dish called duck and chan. Here we have a dry-aged Long Island duck breast roasted in the French way, served with a plate of Korean banchan (a collective name for small side dishes). For the previous four courses, only the porridge may sound a little bit authentically Korean. Finally, in this main course, I am served with the truly authentic banchan. The duck here is averagely prepared. I failed to detect much flavor even though it is dry-aged. The skin is crispy, and the fat lying underneath is rich in umami. The flesh per se, however, is not succulent enough, thus flavors aren't delivered well enough. Nevertheless, the duck breast tastes much better with the banchan small dishes.

For the Korean banchan small side dishes, we have eight varieties here: herbs-mustard sauce, grilled Brussels sprouts, persimmon, soy-glazed eggplant, Korean phogo mushroom, charred cucumber, cabbage kimchi, and perilla leaf with soybean paste and Asian pear. Herbs-mustard sauce is a little bit strong that is overshadowing the flavor of the duck. It is more likely to be a proper sauce for lamb chops. Persimmon is an interesting but successful pair. After all, duck always goes along well with sweets. The soy-glazed eggplant is a truly amazing counterpart to the duck, and the most impressive pairing would be the perilla leaf with soybean paste and Asian pear.





DANHOBAK

The first dessert on the menu is a dessert that features the theme of pumpkin, one of the most iconic plants of the season. The dessert consists of a brown butter ice cream quenelle bathed in the translucent silky pumpkin purée with fresh pumpkin balls and black sugar boba, topped with a leaf-shaped pumpkin tuile. The contrast in texture is the most successful element in this course, and the combination of brown butter and pumpkin works out perfectly. The only flaw could be the boba, which is too large in terms of size and is just not proper for a fine-dining course. Tapioca could be an ideal substitute.

HOTTEOK

At the end of this degustation journey, a Korean sweet pancake is presented. The pancake is glazed with black sugar and then topped with candied pecan and cashew. I always disliked the idea to end a meal with a dessert that could be seen on a breakfast menu, for instance, not only this pancake but also the Tarte Tatin in the case of Momofuku Ko. Such desserts usually show little delicacy and have less room for flavors to shine through. In this case, the pancake is on the dry side, and the requirement of enjoying it with hands is literally unenjoyable. This method may be the authentic way of eating it, but it is simply too awkward to do so in a fine-dining space, considering the pancake's size. This could be the ruiner of the whole menu, unfortunately.

